

Man (Manda) Yao

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EMPLOYMENT

2024-present Denison University
Assistant Professor, Women's and Gender Studies Program
Affiliated with Data Analytics Program and East Asian Studies Program

EDUCATION

	The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH, USA
2024	Ph.D. , Sociology
2019	M.A. , Sociology
	Renmin University of China, Beijing, China
2017	M.A. , Anthropology
2015	B.A. , Sociology

RESEARCH & TEACHING INTERESTS

Gender Inequality; AI & Digital Technology; Education & Work; Social Psychology;
Culture; Quantitative & Computational Methods; China

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed journal articles:

7. Buchmann, Claudia, Rachel Dwyer, and **Man Yao**. 2025. "The Deepening Gender Divide in Credentials 2000-2020: Continuity, Change, and Implications." *RSF: The Russell Sage Foundation Journal of the Social Sciences*. [[Link](#)]
6. **Yao, Man**. 2024. "Persistence of the Gender Frame: Gender Perceptions of Ambiguous Chinese and Gender-Neutral American Names in the United States." *Gender & Society*, 38(6), 868-901. [[Link](#)]
- Finalist: ASA Culture Section Best Graduate Student Paper
5. Zheng, Hui, Yao Lu, and **Man Yao**. 2024. "Emerging Health Disparities among College Graduates: Understanding the Health Consequences of Education-Occupation Mismatch." *Social Science Research*, 120: 103015. [[Link](#)]
4. **Yao, Man** and Siqi Han. 2024. "Who Earns the Iron Rice Bowl? Major Marketability and State Sector Jobs among College-Educated Workers in Urban China." *Chinese Journal of Sociology*, 10(2), 167-191. [[Link](#)]
- A [brief report](#) in Chinese
3. Downey, Douglas, **Man Yao**, and Joseph Merry. 2023. "The Inverse Association

Between Number of Siblings and Divorce: New Evidence from China and Europe.” *Journal of Family Issues*, 45(4), 890-930. [[Link](#)]
- A [brief report](#) in Chinese

2. **Yao, Man**. 2023. “Graduate school, Work, or Unclear? Gender Differences in the Post-college Plans among China’s Recent College Graduates.” *Sociological Perspectives*, 66(2), 246–275. [[Link](#)]
- A [brief report](#) in Chinese
1. **Yao, Man**, Tori I. Rehr, and Erica P. Regan. 2023. “Gender Differences in Financial Knowledge among College Students: Evidence from a Recent Multi-institutional Survey.” *Journal of Family and Economic Issues*, 44, 693–713. [[Link](#)]

Peer-reviewed book chapters:

1. Buchmann, Claudia, and **Man Yao**. 2025. “Gender as an Axis of Stratification”, in Markus Gangl, and others (eds), *The Oxford Handbook of Social Stratification*. [[Link](#)]

UNDER REVIEW

Yao, Man, Claudia Buchmann, and Zhen Wang. “Gendering the Human-Machine Boundary in the Age of Generative AI” (under review at *New Media & Society*)

Wen, Fangqi, **Man Yao**, and Siqi Han. (Equal Authorship). “Discrimination Through Formalization: Gender Preference and Ideal Composition in China’s Civil Service Recruitment.” (under review at *American Sociological Review*)

Song, Haoming and **Man Yao**. “The Disapproval of Homosexuality at the Intersection of Gender and Education.” (revise & resubmit at *Social Science Research*)

Yao, Man and Haoming Song. “Both Feminine and Masculine? Gender Blend Identity Across Educational and Occupational Groups.” (revise & resubmit for a special issue about gradational measures of gender at *RSF: The Russell Sage Foundation Journal of the Social Sciences*)

WORK IN PROGRESS

Yao, Man, and Shiri Noy. “Occupational AI Exposure and Labor Market Outcomes in Global Contexts.” (data analysis)

Yao, Man, Tongyu Wu, and Yue Lu. “Expert in the Loop: Boundary Work of White-Collar Professionals in AI Training.” (data collection)

Wang, Zhen and **Man Yao**. “Seeking Emotional Support from AI: User Demographics, Responses, and Impacts on Wellbeing.” (proposal submitted)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Denison University

- WGST 310: Feminist Research Methods
- WGST 286: When AI Meets Feminism
- WGST 289: Gender and Digital Society
- WGST 101: Issues in Feminism

The Ohio State University

- SOC 1101: Introduction to Sociology (Independent instructor)
- SOC 3549: Social Research Methods (Lab instructor)
- SOC 3302: Technology and Society (Graduate Teaching Assistant)

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, & AWARDS

2026	Denison ITS Digital Innovation Grant (\$1,500)
2026	Denison University Research Foundation Award (\$9,500)
2026	Denison Lisska Center Summer Scholars Mentor (\$3,000)
2023	Center for Ethnic Studies Student Research Grant at OSU (\$600)
2022	ASA Culture Section Richard Peterson Graduate Student Paper Award, Finalist
2022	Distinguished University Fellowship, The Ohio State University (\$36,000)
2020	Silverman Research Award, The Ohio State University (\$1,700)
2018	Summer Methods Training Award, The Ohio State University (\$2,000)
2017	Distinguished University Fellowship, The Ohio State University (\$ 26,000)
2016	Best Fieldwork Report, Fieldwork Foundation of China
2016	Kwang-Hua Scholarship, Renmin University of China
2015	Distinguished Postgraduate Scholarship, Renmin University of China
2015	Ethnographic Research Grant, Tencent Research Institute

CONFERENCE & INVITED PRESENTATIONS

2026	“Discrimination Through Formalization: Gender Preference and Ideal Composition in China’s Civil Service Recruitment.” Annual Meeting of the American Sociology Association, New York, New York, August. (with Fangqi Wen and Siqi Han)
2025	“Framed by Gender: Users’ Interactions with Generative AI.” Annual Meeting of the American Sociology Association, Chicago, IL, August. (with Claudia Buchmann and Zhen Wang)
2025	“The Disapproval of Homosexuality at the Intersection of Gender and Education.” Annual Meeting of the American Sociology Association, Chicago, IL, August. (with Haoming Song)
2025	“Teaching Sociology.” Invited panelist at California State University San Marcos.
2024	“Gender Framing in the Digital Age.” Invited talk at China Women’s University.
2023	“The Deepening Gender Divide in Credentials 2000-2020: Continuity, Change,

- and Implications.” International Sociological Association Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility Summer Meeting, Ann Arbor, MI, August. (with Claudia Buchmann and Rachel Dwyer)
- 2023 “Emerging Health Disparities among College Graduates: Understanding the Health Consequence of Education-Occupation Mismatch.” Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, New Orleans, LA, April. (with Hui Zheng and Yao Lu)
- 2022 “Unfamiliar Foreign Name, Cold Chinese Man: How Cultural Schema Shapes Gender Meanings of Chinese Names.” Research on East Asian Demography and Inequality Seminar, Princeton University, November. (Zoom)
- 2022 “Unfamiliar Foreign Name, Cold Chinese Man: How Cultural Schema Shapes Gender Meanings of Chinese Names.” Annual Meeting of the American Sociology Association, Los Angeles, CA, August.
- 2022 “Who Earns the Iron Rice Bowl? Major Marketability and State Sector Jobs among College-Educated Workers in Urban China.” International Sociological Association Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility, University of Notre Dame, IN, August. (with Siqi Han)
- 2022 “Field of Study, Employment Sector, and Intergenerational Mobility among College Graduates in Urban China.” Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America, Atlanta, GA, April. (with Siqi Han)
- 2021 “Number of Siblings and Divorce in East Asia.” Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America. (with Douglas Downey) (Zoom)
- 2020 “The Gender Divide in Gaming and Careers Aspirations in Computing: A Cross-national Analysis.” Annual Meeting of the American Sociology Association. (with Claudia Buchmann) (cancelled due to Covid-19)
- 2019 “Graduate School, Work, or Unclear? Gender Differences in the Post-college Plans among China’s Recent College Graduates.” Annual Meeting of the American Sociology Association, New York, NY, August.

METHODS TRAINING & WORK EXPERIENCE

Methods Training

- 2026 Future of Work in the Age of LLMs, Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics
- 2025 Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, Social Media Lab, Stanford University
- 2022 Experimental Sociology Workshop, Social Research Institute, University College London
- 2021 Computational Text Analysis Workshop, Department of Sociology, The Ohio State University
- 2020 R Workshop, Translational Data Analytics Institute, The Ohio State

2019	University Python Workshop, Institute of Population Research, The Ohio State University
2018	Causal Inference in Social Sciences, University of Michigan-Peking University Joint Institute

Work Experience & Translation

2025	English-to-Chinese translation: 《数字鸿沟：科技时代美国学校如何制造不平等》. 中国人民大学出版社. (Rafalow, Matthew H. “Digital divisions: How schools create inequality in the tech era.” University of Chicago Press, 2020.)
2020-2021	Graduate Administrative Assistant, Center for the Study of Student Life, The Ohio State University - Conducted instrument development, survey distribution, data analysis, and report writing for more than 20 projects.
2021	User Experience Researcher Intern, Autodesk Inc., San Francisco, California - Applied expertise in social science research and statistical methods to monitor user behaviors and satisfaction.

SERVICE AND PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Ad Hoc Reviewer for Journals:

American Sociological Review, Social Forces, Sociology of Education, Research in Social Stratification and Mobility, Demography, Social Science Research, The Sociological Quarterly, Deviant Behavior, Demographic Research, Work and Occupations, Humanities and Social Sciences Communications

Service to Professional Association:

- 2026, session organizer for invited session “Diversifying STEM Workforce in Global Contexts” at American Sociological Association (ASA)
- 2026, committee member of Graduate Student Investigator Committee for the Social Psychology Section at ASA
- 2025, graduate student mentor for Sex and Gender Section and Science, Knowledge, and Technology Section at ASA
- 2025, session presider for “Change and Continuity in Family and Kinship” at ASA
- 2022-2024, newsletter editor for Sociology of Culture Section at ASA

Service to Denison University & Women’s and Gender Studies Program:

- 2025-2026, Women’s Empowerment Series Committee (role: Department representative)
- 2025-2026, Nan Nowik Awards Committee (role: committee member)
- 2025-2026, session presider, GLCA Women’s, Gender, and Sexuality Studies Collective Undergraduate Research and Activism e-Conference

Service to The Ohio State University & Sociology Department:

- 2021, Graduate Studies Working Group (role: graduate student representative)

- 2021, Director of Center for Study of Student Life Search Committee (role: committee member)
- 2019-2024, Graduate student mentor

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

R (*multilevel modeling, topic modeling, sentiment analysis*), Stata (*general linear models, longitudinal data analysis, sequence analysis, causal inference*), Python (*topic modeling, word embeddings*), SPSS, NVivo (*qualitative data coding and analysis*), Qualtrics (*online survey design and distribution*)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

American Sociological Association, Sociologists for Women in Society, International Sociological Association Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility, National Women's Studies Association

REFERENCES

Available upon request